

REJO Z MATHEW

Chicago, IL – Open to Relocation | rejozacharia@gmail.com | (707) 456-7356 | rejozmathew.com | linkedin.com/in/rejozmathew | [GitHub](https://github.com)

Senior data, analytics, and AI leader with 20+ years modernizing enterprise data ecosystems, building scalable cloud-native data platforms, and driving AI/ML-powered transformation across financial services, with deep experience in consumer banking and lending. Expert in enabling enterprise AI adoption through governed data foundations, decisioning frameworks, and responsible AI in regulated environments. Recognized for leading global teams, partnering with C-suite stakeholders to shape enterprise data & AI strategy, and delivering customer-centric capabilities that drive experiences and business performance.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Strategy & Leadership: Enterprise Data & AI Strategy, Architecture & Modernization | Technical Program & Data Product Management | Cross-Functional Stakeholder Partnership | Global Team Leadership & Development

Platform & Technology: Cloud-Native Data Platforms (AWS, GCP, Snowflake, Databricks, Spark) | Knowledge Graph & Semantic Layer (Neo4j, AtScale, Tableau) | MarTech & CRM Integration (Adobe, Segment, Salesforce)

AI/ML & Governance: AI/GenAI Lifecycle & Responsible AI (ML, LLMs, Agentic AI, MLOps, Observability) | Data Governance, Quality, Metadata & Lineage | Regulatory Compliance (KYC/AML, TCPA, GLBA, PCI DSS, GDPR/CCPA)

Domain Expertise: Consumer Banking & Lending | Predictive Analytics, Personalization & Decision Intelligence

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Sr. Director, Data, Analytics & AI, Discover Financial Services, Chicago

June 2022 – May 2026

- Drove Discover's **enterprise data & AI platform transformation**, delivering a modern cloud-native analytics environment (AWS, Snowflake) with improved scalability, interoperability, and AI/ML readiness.
- Integrated MarTech, CRM, digital, and core banking data into the enterprise platform, enabling AI-driven personalization and decisioning that delivered **~\$100M** in measurable business impact.
- Developed **Enterprise Identity Knowledge Graph** (Neo4j) and Customer 360 platform, unifying customer data for entity resolution, contextual analytics, and AI decisioning across business units.
- Directed data workstreams for Discover's \$9B student-loan portfolio migration and divestiture, partnering with Finance on balance walk validation across 2M+ accounts with 20-year history, collection curves, and vintage analysis supporting portfolio sale.
- Orchestrated customer data consolidation and account reconciliation for **Capital One's \$35B acquisition of Discover** — integrating customer records across core banking, and CRM systems under regulatory timelines to deliver Day 1 operational readiness.
- Operationalized **GenAI and ML** use cases — LLM summarization, RAG-based document matching, ML classification — with human-in-the-loop (HITL) validation and governed workflows for enterprise-grade adoption.
- Built **governance and observability** frameworks for production data and AI systems — data quality, lineage, drift monitoring, and explainability — enabling auditable delivery in a regulated environment.
- Partnered **with C-level** executives as an **AI/Data advisor** to shape enterprise data & AI strategy, drive data literacy, and guide AI adoption across the organization.
- Managed cross-functional product backlogs across Risk, Marketing, Finance, and Compliance — prioritizing competing initiatives, making scope trade-offs, and shipping iteratively via Kanban/Jira.
- Oversaw a global, full-stack data organization of **~75 professionals** (incl ~50 contractors) data scientists, analysts, data product managers, and engineers — driving high performance through a product-oriented delivery model.

Director, Data, Analytics & AI, Discover Financial Services, Chicago

Oct 2018 – June 2022

- Appointed under a **mandate from the President of Consumer Banking** to build enterprise data and analytics capabilities — scaled a cross-functional team supporting all Consumer Banking business lines.
- Architected and scaled an **enterprise ML feature store** supporting AI/ML use cases across credit risk, retention, CLV, and customer analytics, enabling consistent, production-ready features for downstream models.
- Delivered **self-service BI capabilities** for all Consumer Banking business lines, significantly accelerating insight delivery and democratizing access to curated data assets.
- Designed an enterprise marketing analytics database anchored on first-party data, enabling privacy-compliant campaign targeting, execution, and measurement across channels in a post-GDPR/CCPA landscape.
- Developed balance history and portfolio analytics data framework for consumer loan products, supporting Finance, Credit strategy and BU analytics teams with reconciliation, trend analysis, and regulatory reporting.
- Implemented centralized control and exception management (ServiceNow) to support CFPB consent order remediation — establishing audit trails, escalation workflows, and closed-loop tracking across compliance functions.
- Served as **Chief Data Steward** for Consumer Banking, advancing governance frameworks, data-quality standards, and control policies to strengthen regulatory compliance and analytic reliability.

Sr. Manager, Analytics, BI & Pricing, Discover Financial Services, Chicago

Jul 2016 – Oct 2018

- Stood up the analytical data environment and BI infrastructure from the ground up following an origination system migration, enabling enterprise reporting and marketing analytics for Discover Home Loans.
- Designed and operationalized a **multi-touch attribution (MTA) model**, quantifying channel contribution and informing marketing investment decisions across digital and offline campaigns.
- Redesigned risk-based pricing models and product structures, improving loan portfolio profitability and driving a **20% increase in ROE** while enhancing conversion performance.
- Partnered with Treasury and Credit Risk on fund transfer pricing (FTP) and equity allocation analysis, optimizing lending margins and cost-of-capital allocation for the home equity product.

Manager, Analytics & Data Management, Discover Financial Services, Chicago

Jul 2014 – Jul 2016

Led operational analytics and management reporting for the strategy and operations group of Discover Home Loans.

Project Manager, Analytics, Discover Financial Services, Chicago

Apr 2012 – Jul 2014

Delivered business analytics and management reporting for Discover Home Loans.

PREVIOUS EXPERIENCE

Senior Business Analyst, American Express, Phoenix

Apr 2010 – Apr 2012

Managed multi-million-dollar transformation and reporting projects for the Membership Rewards team.

Senior Consultant, Summer Associate, Deloitte Consulting LLP, Chicago

Jun 2008 – Aug 2008

Developed a \$40M business reengineering plan for a major healthcare insurer to transform its BI ecosystem.

Assistant System Engineer, Tata Consultancy Services, India

Feb 2007 – Jul 2007

Led a team developing technology solutions for American Express products.

Senior Software Engineer, UST Global, India

Dec 2003 – Oct 2006

Early career in enterprise software engineering for clients in insurance and financial services (American Express, FNIS).

EDUCATION

Chief Digital Officer Program, Executive Education | 2024

Kellogg School of Management, Northwestern University

MBA, Finance, Marketing & Operations Management | 2009

Kelley School of Business, Indiana University

B.Tech., Electrical & Electronics Engineering | 2003

College of Engineering, University of Kerala, India

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Data Management Professional (CDMP) | AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner | MLOps Specialization (DeepLearning.AI)

THOUGHT LEADERSHIP, PUBLICATIONS & SPEAKING

- **Enterprise Identity Graph:** A practitioner's guide to building a Neo4j-based identity graph that serves marketing attribution, fraud detection, and privacy compliance from a single unified data layer. *Presented at Neo4j Graph Summit Chicago 2025.*
- **Enterprise Data Modernization:** A domain-centric architecture framework that resolves inconsistent metrics, unvalidated data, and unknown provenance through semantic layers, lineage, and observability — the governed data infrastructure AI agents now depend on.
- **Inside an Enterprise AI/ML Platform:** End-to-end MLOps in a regulated environment — cloud-native workbench, governed code promotion, feature store design, production monitoring tiers, and GenAI extension.
- **Responsible RAG for Document Matching:** A governed RAG pipeline with LLM extraction and human-in-the-loop (HITL) controls for resolving legacy document-to-account matching at scale.
- **ML-Driven Marketing Personalization:** Replacing rules-based segmentation with an ML decisioning engine — a hybrid GBDT + DNN architecture that optimizes offer selection across channels in real time.
- **Controls Monitoring Operating Model:** A practitioner's framework for connecting regulatory control obligations to active monitoring, exception tracking, incident triage, and remediation — the operating architecture that makes compliance measurable.
- **ML-Powered Call Center Monitoring:** A dual-track framework for transcript-based monitoring controls — traditional ML for auditable regulatory detection, GenAI for operational intelligence like agent coaching and call summarization.

Full portfolio and articles: www.rejozmathew.com/portfolio